

MUST FOR EVERY STUDENT ... FOR ALL COMPETITIVE EXAMS

ENGLISH MADE SIMPLE!

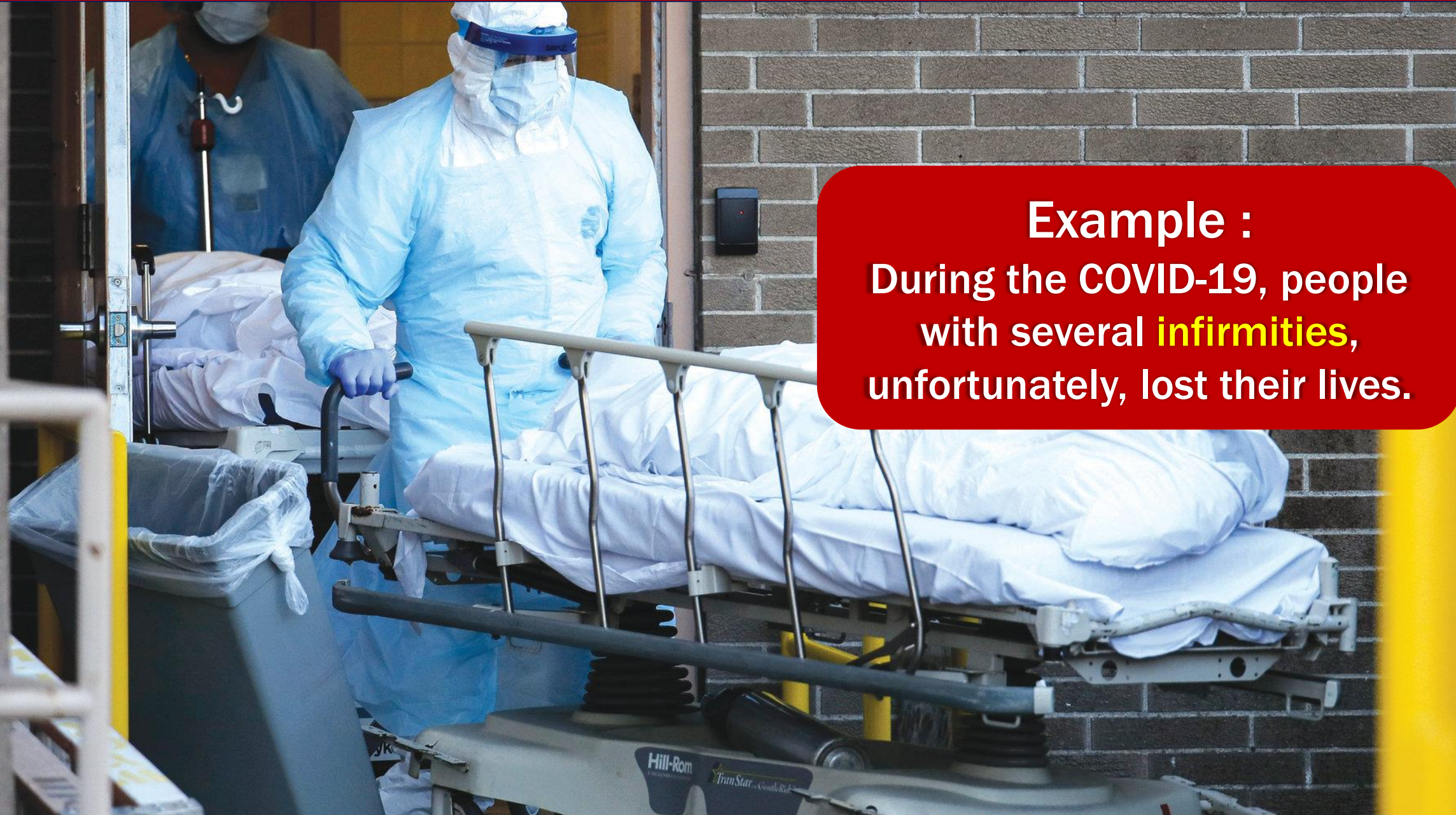
LEARN WITH GVR SIR

MODULE - 21



Infirmity : *Illness for long periods/old age.*

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Example :
During the COVID-19, people
with several **infirmities**,
unfortunately, lost their lives.

Infirmity : *Physical/mental weakness*

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Example :
Old age people with **infirmities** normally stay with their adult children.

Preponderance : *The largest part /greatest amount.*

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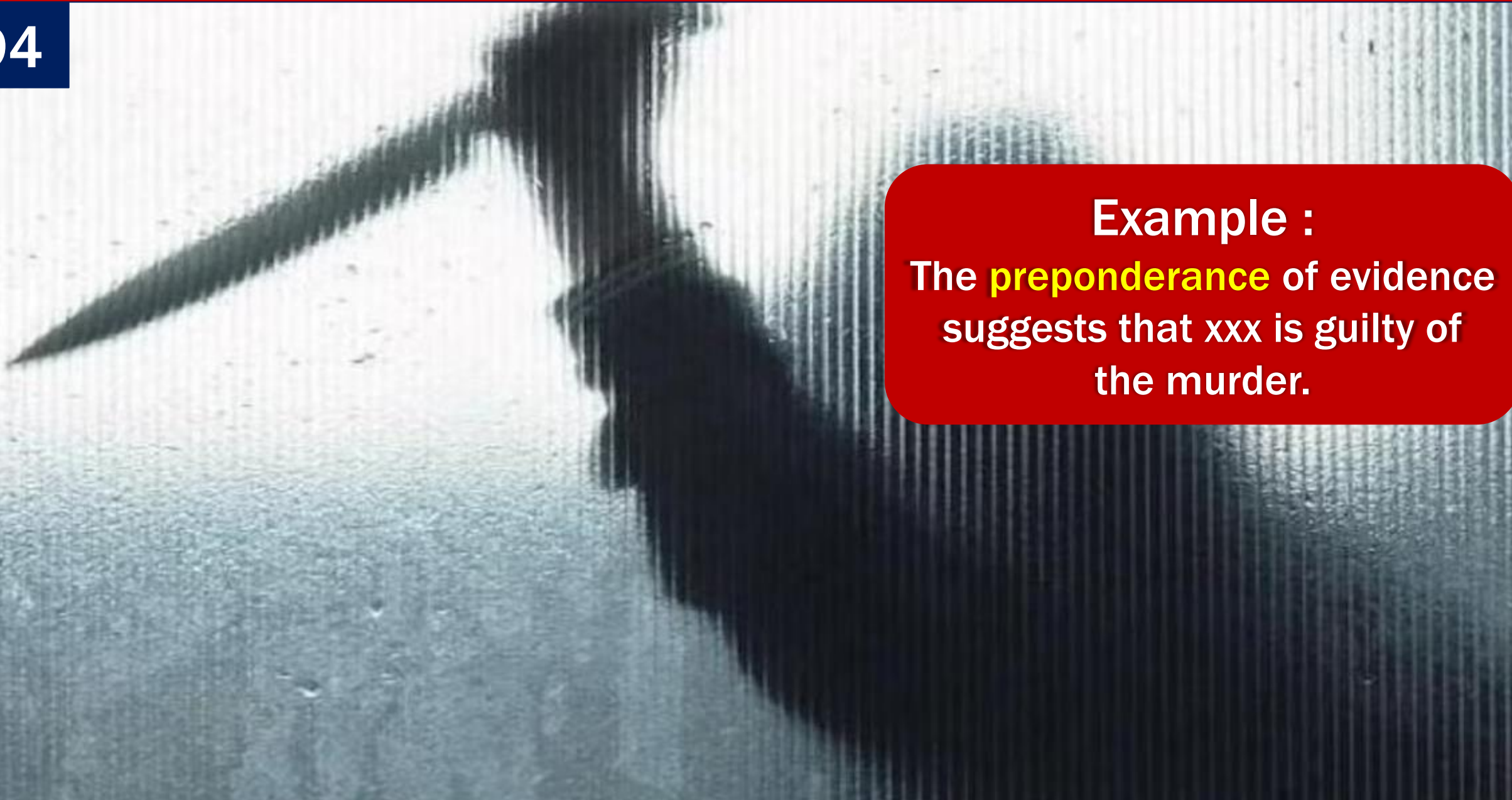


Example :

The traditional jewellery companies of the 20th century have a **preponderance** of middle/old aged customers and now they hope to attract younger generation of people.

Preponderance : *The largest part /greatest amount.*

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Example :
The **preponderance** of evidence suggests that xxx is guilty of the murder.

Insulation : *The act of covering something to stop heat / sound / electricity from escaping or entering.*

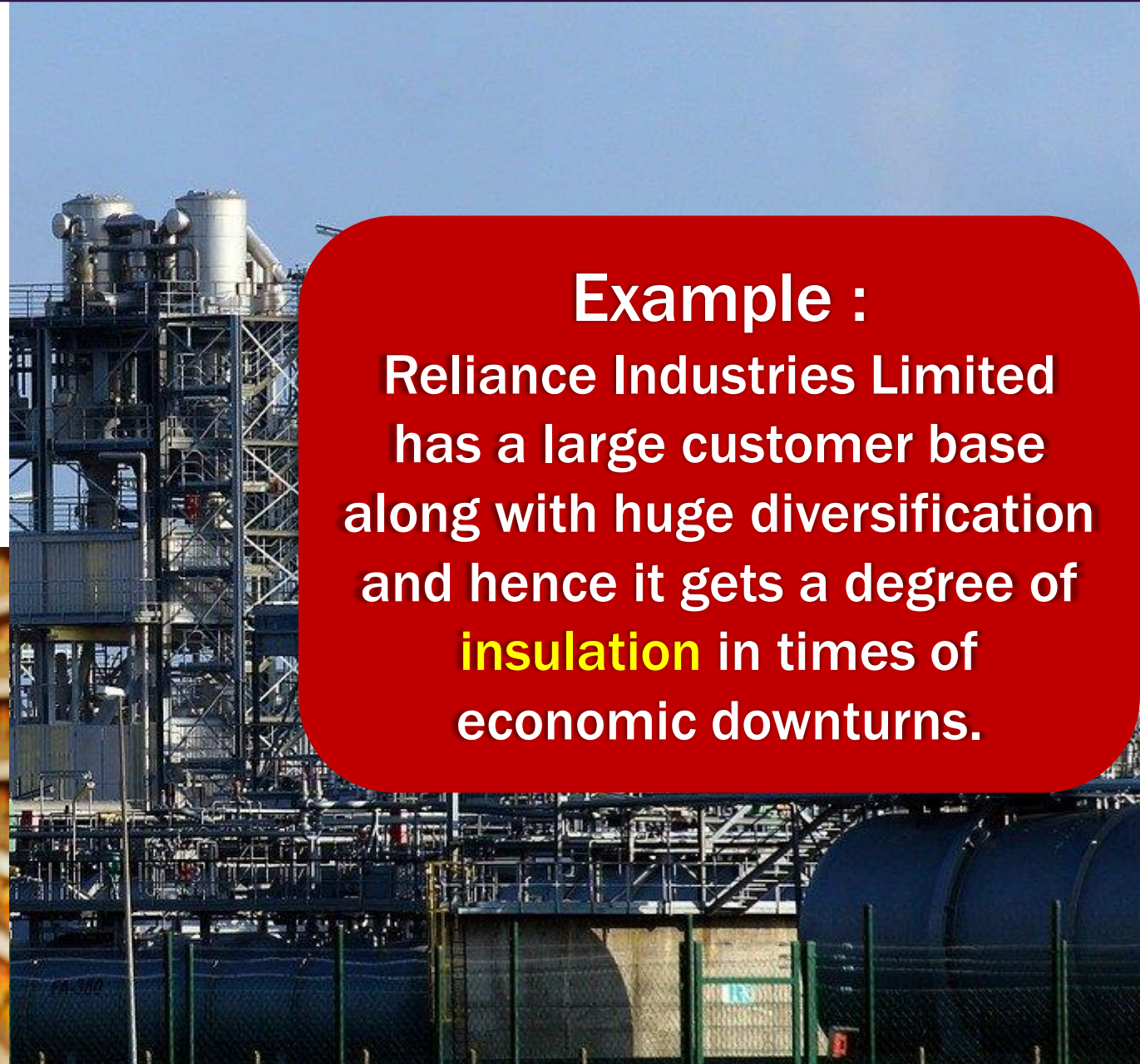
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Example :
The animals in the cold regions have thick fur and this gives very good **insulation** against the biting cold.

Insulation : *The fact of being protected from something harmful.*

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Example :
Reliance Industries Limited has a large customer base along with huge diversification and hence it gets a degree of **insulation** in times of economic downturns.

Sine qua non : *Necessary condition without which something is not possible.*

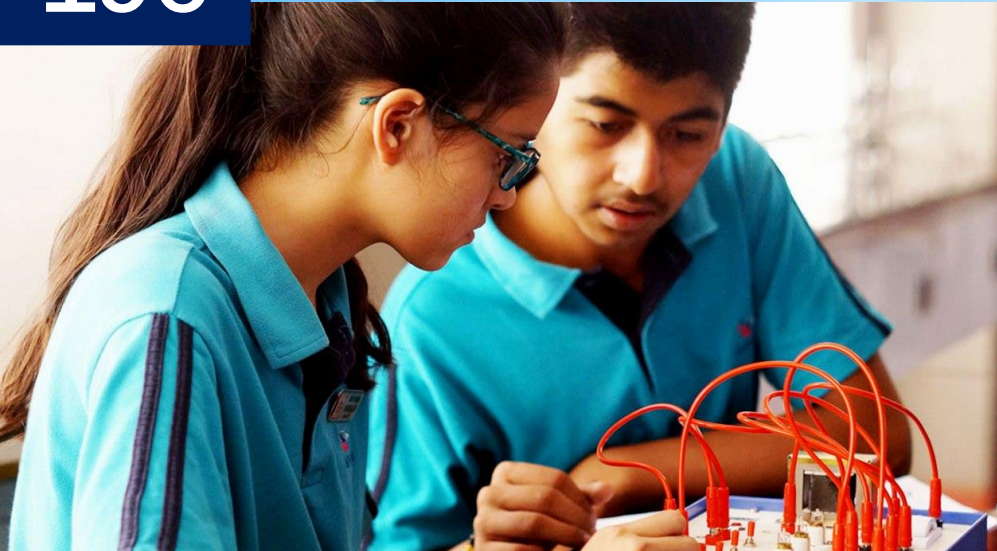
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Example :
To become a developed country by 2047, increase in R&D expenditure is a **sine qua non** for India.

Sine qua non : *Something that must be done or achieved before anything else is done or achieved.*

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Example :
Quality education with skilling
is **sine qua non** for achieving
10% GDP growth rates in India.

Seminal : *Containing important new ideas and having a great influence on later work.*

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Example :
Bindeshwar Pathak, who died recently at the age of 80, has done **seminal** work in freeing manual scavengers.

Seminal : *Containing important new ideas and having a great influence on later work.*

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Example :
John wrote **seminal** article on apartheid, while he was still a student.

Misgiving : *A feeling of doubt or apprehension about the outcome or consequences of something.*

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Example :
The employees of Byju's have **misgivings** about the way the company is being run.

Autocracy : *Government by a single person or a small group that has unlimited power or authority.*

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Example :
Nowadays several
Governments across the World
can be considered **autocracies**.

Aristocracy : *A class of people who hold high social rank /
Government ruled by the people of a high social class.*

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Example :
Government of the people and
by the people is entirely
different from monarchy or
aristocracy.



Era : *This is the period of time of which particular events / stages of development occurred.*

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Example :
Our bureaucracy, in general, failed in delivering services in Independent India due to the hangover from the colonial **era**.

Colonialism : *The system of one country controlling another.*

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Example :
After the Second World War,
the era of **colonialism** has been
on the wane.



The Indian EXPRESS

03-10-2023

JUSTICE COUNTS

Bihar's caste survey is welcome but it should be used to increase opportunity, not as a primer for deepening faultlines

THE RELEASE OF the caste survey data in Bihar is a much-needed and long-overdue step for the state's politics and policy. Caste numbers can provide a critical reality check for governments that make "samajik nyaya" or social justice their calling card, or claim to. Data can help fine-tune efforts to address historically embedded backwardness and inequality. A wider political churning was touched off in the 1990s with the implementation of the Mandal Commission report at the Centre — it inaugurated and then routinised such a politics in the country's north (the states of the south had already taken a lead) by mobilising historically neglected constituencies, empowering new parties and players, and expanding quotas in education and jobs to include the OBCs. Counting caste numbers is a logical next step that, at the national level, has been delayed much too long. That's why the Bihar numbers, even as they promise to fill a gap in the state, will also resonate beyond it.

Within the state, by assigning the highest percentage of all caste groups, 36.01 per cent, to the Extremely Backward Castes (EBCs), the survey promises a new dignity, if not coherence, to the mostly small and scattered groups, seen as politically footloose, in this category. For long, the dominant Backward versus Forward cleavage in the state relegated these groups to the margins, and the absence of a unified EBC leadership has meant that political parties ranging from the RJD and JD(U) to the BJP, that have sought to coopt them, have struck bargains that assign their concerns less than their due space and role. The politics of the EBC may well receive a new fillip now in Bihar. Ahead of the general election in 2024, Bihar's survey will also amplify other calls for enumeration outside the state — the women's Bill has just been passed by Parliament with the question of quota-within-quota still hanging; the Justice G Rohini Commission recently submitted its report on the sub-categorisation of OBCs; the Modi government is reportedly discussing a proposal for sub-categorisation among SCs; the Opposition alliance, INDIA, is pushing for a country-wide caste census, ostensibly to counter the BJP's Hindutva consolidation, and many states are pushing for independent caste-based surveys in their own jurisdictions.

Even as a caste headcount is necessary and desirable in a deeply stratified society, in which caste-based reservation has become an important instrument to address historical injustice, the data must be handled with care. The challenge, going ahead, is this: The data must not become a weapon for deepening faultlines and increasing polarisation to win elections. It should not lead to the splintering and shrinking of the very notion of representation in a large and diverse democracy. Politicians will need to remind themselves of the larger purpose: Caste must be counted in order to strengthen efforts to transcend it. In a changing India, in which education and technology are important equalising forces, caste-based affirmative action, fine-tuned with the help of caste numbers, can spur larger conversations on aspiration and ambition, freedom and opportunity, and the need for an eco-system in which citizens are neither unfairly privileged nor straitjacketed by their identities. A series of recent electoral verdicts have driven home the fact that the people may be ahead of their politicians in recognising the future citizenship — while party campaigns all too often play upon fixed identities, voters are increasingly crossing caste and community lines and voting for moveable concerns, shared ideas and dreams.

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